Debbie Amewu

Darla Moore School of Business, University of South Carolina,
1014 Greene Street, Columbia, SC 29208

LinkedIn: debbie-amewu | Email: damewu@email.sc.edu | Phone: +1-803-363-7184

Research Interests

Applied Microeconomics, Law and Economics, Economics of Crime & Public Economics

Education

2022 - present	Ph.D. in Economics, University of South Carolina, United States
2019 - 2020	MSc. Economics, University of Warwick, Coventry, United Kingdom
2014 - 2018	B.A. Economics (First Class), University of Ghana, Legon, Ghana,

Research

Working Papers

1. "The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia"
2. "Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections"
3. "Do Prison Reforms Work: Evidence Based on the Justice Reinvestment Initiative"

Works In Progress

1. "Can Machine Learning Improve Pretrial Risk Assessment? Evidence from Virginia's Public Safety Assessment"

Scholarships/Awards/Grants

2026-2027	Ronald and Charlotte Wilder Economics Annual Fellowship Fund
2025	Darla Moore School of Business Research Grant, with Phil Brookins and Cooper Woodham ($5,000)
2022	Graduate Assistantship at the University of South Carolina
2019	Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) Scholarship

Conference Presentations & Attendances

2027 (Scheduled) **American Economic Association conference, Washington, DC**
The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia

2026 (Scheduled) **Association of Public Policy and Management, Boston, MA**
The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia

2026 (Scheduled) **Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX**
The Impact of Expanding Pretrial Release: Evidence from the Repeal of Presumptions Against Bail in Virginia

2025 **Association of Public Policy and Management, Seattle, WA**
Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections

2025 **Interdisciplinary Policing Workshop, University of South Carolina, SC**
Do Leadership Transitions Degrade Law Enforcement? Evidence from Sheriff Elections

2024 **Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, Clemson University, SC**

2023 **Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day, University of South Carolina, SC**

Teaching Experience

Primary Instructor:

- ECON 224 Introduction to Economics (Fall 2026)
- ECON 224 Introduction to Economics (Fall 2025)

Teaching Assistant:

- Public Finance ECON562 (Spring 2023)
- Principles of Microeconomics ECON221 (Spring 2023)
- Political Economy ECON516 (Fall 2022)
- Industrial Organization ECON515 (Spring 2023)
- Health Economics HSPM412 (Fall 2023, Spring 2024)

Work Experience

Research Experience

Aug 2024 - Apr 2025	Research Assistant to Dr. Jessica Brown and Dr. Chris Herbst: "Impact of private equity ownership status on child care companies."
Aug 2024 - Dec 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. Lindsey Woodworth: "The impact of sheriff characteristics on death investigations".
May 2024 - Aug 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. David Fuente:- Projects involved analysing the impact of various experiments to encourage payment of utility bills in several African countries.
May 2024 - Aug 2024	Research Assistant to Dr. Orgul Ozturk
May 2023 - July 2023	Research Assistant to Dr. Felipe Saenz

Professional Experience

2020-2022	Consultant, Credit Administration Department, PwC, Ghana
2018-2019	Associate, Advisory LoS, PricewaterhouseCoopers Ghana Limited
June - July 2017	Call Centre Intern, Dalex Finance and Leasing Company, Ghana

Languages

English:	Fluent
Akan:	Native

Technical Skills

Programming Languages	Python, LATEX
Software	Stata, zTree, MS Office.

References

Lindsey Woodworth (Committee Chair)
Department of Economics
University of South Carolina
lindsey.woodworth@moore.sc.edu
+1 (803) 777 3602

Sarah Walfogel
Department of Economics
University of South Carolina
sarah.waldfogel@moore.sc.edu
+1 (803) 544 1271

Danna Thomas
Department of Economics
University of South Carolina
danna.thomas@moore.sc.edu
+1 (803) 777 4940